

Paul Michel

last updated: February 27th, 2026

Contact address University of Cologne
Department of Political Science
IBW building
Herbert-Lewin-Straße 2
50931 Cologne, Germany

Email address michel@wiso.uni-koeln.de

Telephone number +49 221 470-76359

Nationality Germany

Education

since 05/2023	University of Cologne
Ph.D. candidate Political Science	
10/2020 – 03/2023	University of Göttingen
M.Sc. Development Economics	
04/2015 – 03/2019	University of Mainz
B.A. Political Science	
B.Sc. Economics	
Semester abroad: Nelson Mandela University, Port Elizabeth, South Africa	

Publications

“Cohesion Among Whom? Stayees, Displaced, and Returnees in Conflict Contexts” (with Tilman Brück, Sarah Langlotz, Patricia Justino, and Philip Verwimp), *Journal of Conflict Resolution* 69(1): 3–16. doi: [10.1177/00220027241254585](https://doi.org/10.1177/00220027241254585).

Working Papers

“Collective Responsibility and Mass Preferences over Climate Action” (*single-authored*)

“Not In My Basement: The Political Consequences of Climate Reforms” (with Michael M. Bechtel and Nils Blossey)

“Risk and Rescue: Irregular Migration Across Origin and Transit” (with Sarah Langlotz and Sebastian Leue)

“Mapping Mass Preferences for Carbon Tax Revenue Use in Europe” (with Michael M. Bechtel, Philipp Genschel, and Laura Seelkopf)

“Hidden Champions of the Firewall” (with Nils Blossey, Jasmin Rath, and Jens Wäckerle)

“Fatalists: Climate Beliefs, Time Preferences, and the Great Demographic Reversal” (with Nils Blossey)

Work Experience

since 05/2023	University of Cologne
Research Associate, Political Economy Lab (Prof. Michael Bechtel)	

10/2020 – 08/2022 **University of Göttingen**
Research Assistant, Chair of Development Economics (Prof. Andreas Fuchs)

10/2019 – 09/2020 **Fraunhofer**
Research Assistant, Center for International Management and Knowledge Economy
IMW, Leipzig, Germany

06/2018 – 08/2018 **Auswärtiges Amt (Federal Foreign Office)**
Intern, German Embassy Nairobi, Kenya

08/2017 – 12/2017 **KfW Development Bank**
Intern, Health and Social Security Asia, Frankfurt/Main, Germany

Research Affiliations

since 05/2023 ECONtribute Cluster of Excellence

Presentations

2023:
Annual Conference on Migration and Diversity, WZB Social Science Center, Berlin, Germany

2024:
Departmental Speaker Series, University of Cologne, Germany
EPSA Annual Conference, Cologne, Germany
APSA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, US
Joint Cologne-Zurich Retreat, Filzbach, Switzerland
GESIS Workshop on Earth Observation Data in the Social Sciences, Cologne, Germany

2025:
EPG Conference, Sachseln, Switzerland
Departmental Speaker Series, University of Cologne, Germany
EPSA Annual Conference, Madrid, Spain
ECONtribute Cluster Retreat, Mettmann, Germany
Workshop on the Politics and Irregular Migration, Hamburg, Germany (co-organizer with Sarah Langlotz and Sebastian Leue)
CEMIR Junior Economist Workshop on Migration Research, ifo, Munich, Germany

2026:
Joint Cologne-Zurich-Innsbruck Retreat, Jenbach, Austria
RF-Berlin Migration Forum, Berlin, Germany
International Conference on Migration and Development, Seoul, Republic of Korea
LSE Sustainable Social Policy Workshop, London, United Kingdom
Beyond Basic Questions Conference 2026, Marburg, Germany

Teaching

University of Cologne

Public Policy, tutorial, undergraduate
Voters, Public Opinion, and Policymaking, seminar, undergraduate
Research Logic and Research Design, seminar, undergraduate

University of Mainz

Macroeconomics, tutorial, undergraduate

Microeconomics, exam preparation course, undergraduate
Empirical Economic Research, exam preparation course, undergraduate

Refereeing

British Journal of Political Science; European Journal of Political Research; Journal of Elections, Public Opinion, and Parties; Political Behavior

Grants

2024:

C-SEB Junior StartUp Grant, Center for Social and Economic Behavior, University of Cologne (4000 €)

Dr. Hans-Riegel-Foundation, Connex - Science Networking grant (with Sarah Langlotz and Sebastian Leue) (6.500 €)

2025:

C-SEB Junior StartUp Grant, Center for Social and Economic Behavior, University of Cologne (4000 €)

Selten Seeding Grant, ECONtribute Cluster of Excellence, University of Cologne (5000 €)

German Research Foundation (DFG), Grant for international scientific events (with Sarah Langlotz and Sebastian Leue), Workshop on “Economics and Politics of Irregular Migration” (4500 €)

Languages

German (native)

English (fluent)

French (intermediate)

Software

L^AT_EX (proficient)

MS Word, Excel, Powerpoint (proficient)

Qualtrics (proficient)

R (proficient)

Stata (proficient)

Claude Code (proficient)

Python (intermediate)

QGIS (intermediate)